

Aotearoa AI Hackathon Festival

University of Waikato

What Happens on the Day?



AI Forum
NEW ZEALAND
Te Kāhui Atamai Ihiko o Aotearoa

Day 1

8:40 am Participants and mentors gather

9:00 am Karakia, Briefing, Icebreaking

9:30 am Hackathon Starts: Team forming

10:00 am Mentor check-in

11:00 am Mentor debrief

12:00 pm Teams break out to breakout rooms

Periodic check-in from mentors

(Mentors will be in MSB1.12 if assistance is required)

5:00 pm End of Day 1

Day 2

9:00 am Venue opens

Hackathon continues

Mentors and Tech support available

12:00 pm Pitch practice sessions with mentors

3:00 pm Judges arrive

Introduction to judges

3:30 pm Pitching Session

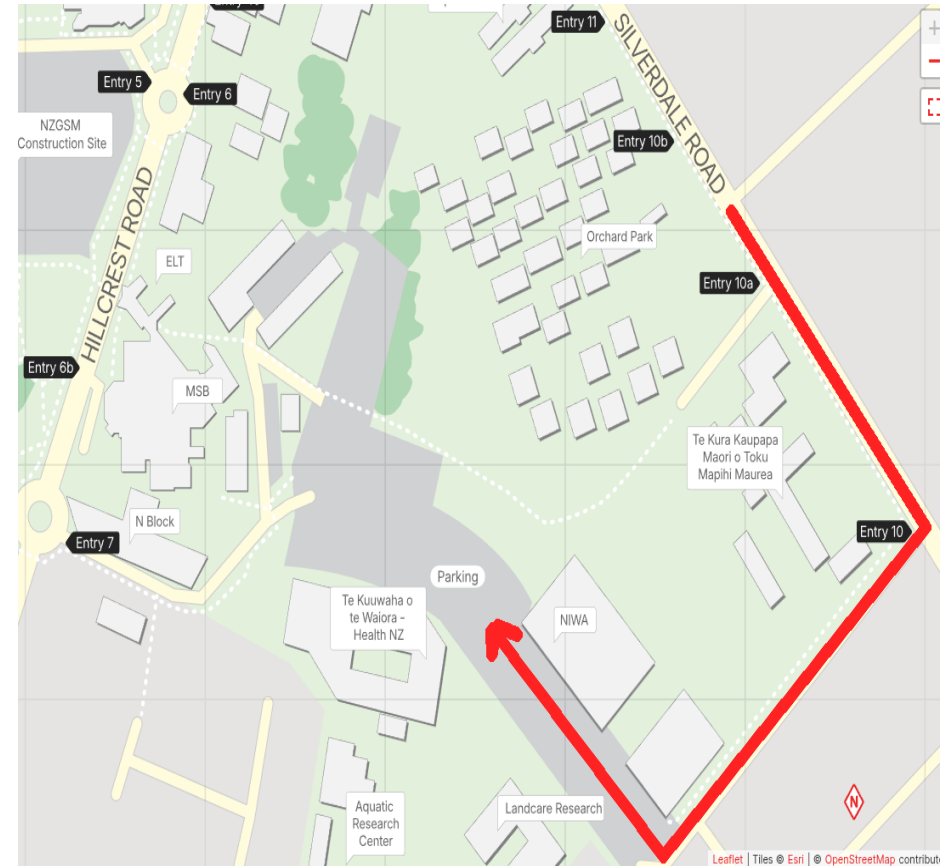
5:00 pm Winners announced

Closing Karakia & Networking celebration

This is a sample Run Sheet. Each venue will differ slightly due to size, number of participants and capabilities.

Parking & Gate 10 Access

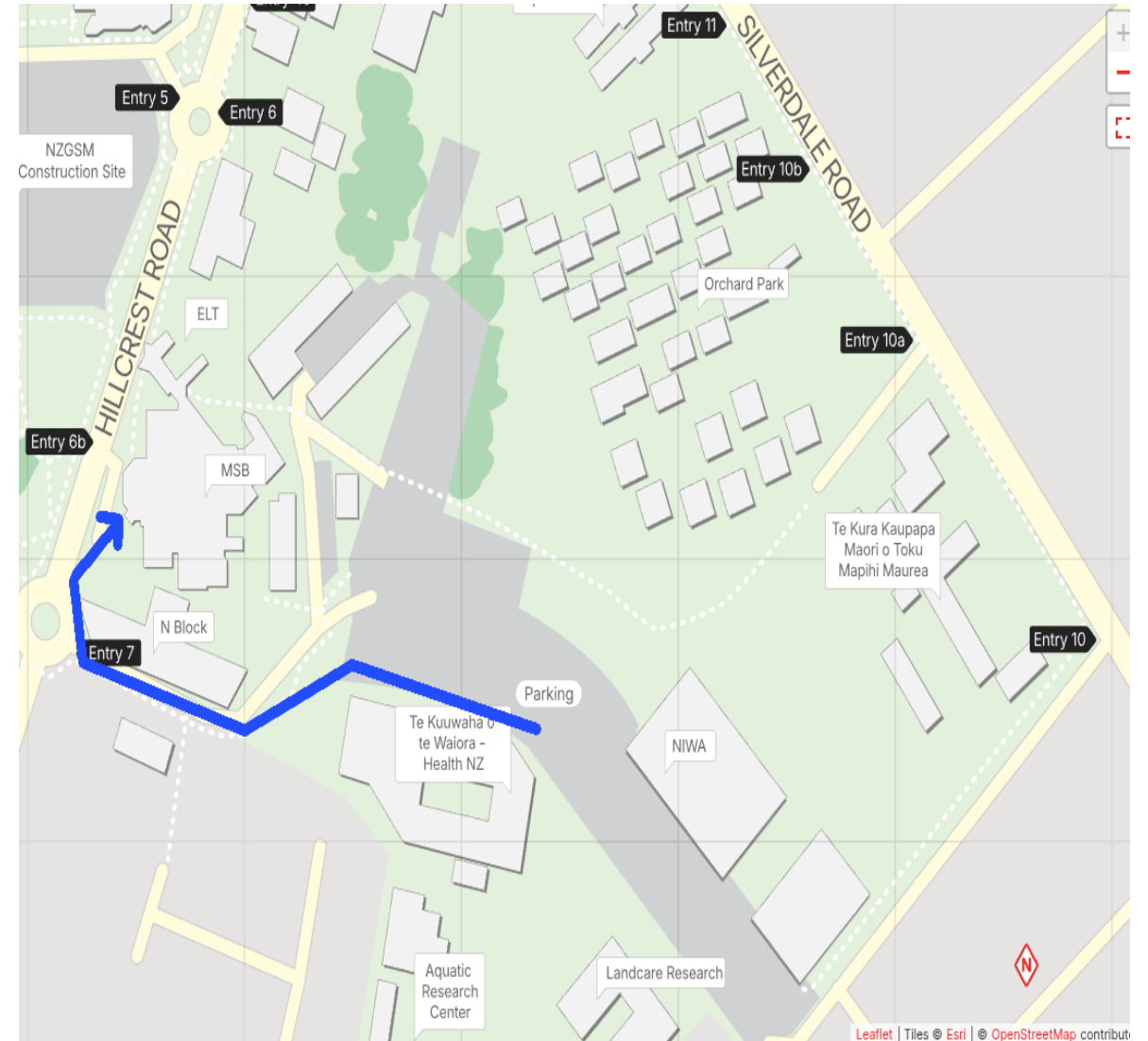
- **Public Parking:** Available at Gate 10.
- **Entrance:** Located off Silverdale Road.
- **Payment:** Managed via the PayMyPark app.



Walk to the Building Entrance

Walkway Route from Gate 10 Parking:

- Follow the road up from Gate 10 at the roundabout.
- Use the pedestrian crossing to go right.
- Continue down the open path until you reach the Management School Building entrance doors. (It would be the second entrance, please do not use the main entrance with the revolving door)



Getting to MSB4.02

Waikato Management School (MSB)

- From the building entrance doors.
- Head right immediately after entering.
- In the next room, you will see stairs and an elevator.
- Take the elevator or stairs to Floor 4.
- MSB4.02 is immediately ahead of you after exiting the elevator or reaching the top of the stairs.

Amenities & Wi-Fi

- **Wi-Fi Network SSID:** **Waikato** (no password required)
- **Mentor Headquarters:** **MSB1.12** if you need assistance during the event.

Forming Teams

You can:

- Register as an individual and join a team on the day
- Register with your team

Building a Team:

Hackathons are a safe space for people from diverse skill sets and backgrounds to come together around a problem to solve.

When forming your team, a good mix of people and skill sets will help you to be successful.

Teams must have a minimum of 3 members and a maximum of 7.

You can come with your team already formed or join one on the first morning.

Mentors will be there to help everyone participate.

Pitch Practice

Day 1

Mentors will check in with each team on Day 1, making sure that you have a problem to solve and a workable idea to solve that.

Day 2

We suggest the team pitch practice begins by 12 noon.

At this point each team usually splits into two groups – those who are continuing to Hack towards the solution and those who are building towards the pitch.

Teams practice their pitches in front of mentors who can help them shape and refine the content and style.

The team comes back together for the 30 minutes between the end of the Hack and the beginning of the pitching.

We provide a pitching template example [here](#)

Each pitch is a maximum 5 minutes long

Participant Rules of Engagement

We are an inclusive festival, welcoming people from all genders, ethnicities and backgrounds. We ask that you:

- Be welcoming to each other and treat everyone with respect.
- Be open to learning new things and form new friendships.
- Be fair. You can pre-plan with your team, but keep to the spirit of the event by collaborating and developing your ideas at the event itself.
- Be respectful. Our hosts are welcoming you into their environments, please follow their guidance and rules.

If you choose not to abide by these rules you may be asked to leave the hackathon.

Intellectual Property

Neither the AI Forum nor any of the supporters of this Festival have any interest in IP created at the event.

For practical purposes, any IP created belongs to the team that created it. Your team may want to discuss how this will work going forward after the event.

Legally, participants must comply with the terms and conditions of any IP ownership rights that already exist regarding the items they use.

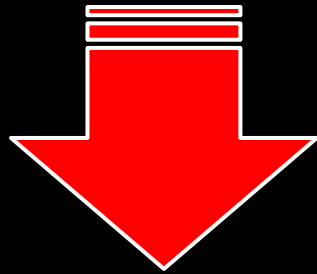
Any rights infringements are at the participant's own risk.



AI Hackathon

We have 4 years to go!

We, the Heads of State and Government and High Representatives, meeting at the United Nations Headquarters in New York from 25-27 September 2015 as the Organization celebrates its seventieth anniversary, have decided today on new global Sustainable Development Goals.....



The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development Goals

On average, globally, only 16% of the SDG targets are on track to be achieved by 2030, with the remaining 84% demonstrating limited or a reversal of progress

Teams can choose to solve a problem from any of the 5 UN SDG categories

You can choose your own problem to solve or use one of our suggestions as inspiration.

Focus on something achievable in the time that you have.

Key: Your problem to solve and how it relates to the UN SDGs must be clearly articulated - and the solution must address that problem.

People

We are determined to end poverty and hunger, in all their forms and dimensions, and to ensure that all human beings can fulfil their potential in dignity and equality and in a healthy environment.

Planet

We are determined to protect the planet from degradation, including through sustainable consumption and production, sustainably managing its natural resources and taking urgent action on climate change, so that it can support the needs of the present and future generations.

Prosperity

We are determined to ensure that all human beings can enjoy prosperous and fulfilling lives and that economic, social and technological progress occurs in harmony with nature.

Peace

We are determined to foster peaceful, just and inclusive societies which are free from fear and violence. There can be no sustainable development without peace and no peace without sustainable development.

Partnership

We are determined to mobilize the means required to implement this Agenda through a revitalised Global Partnership for Sustainable Development, based on a spirit of strengthened global solidarity, focussed in particular on the needs of the poorest and most vulnerable and with the participation of all countries, all stakeholders and all people.

This deck is full of ideas for problems to solve and how AI might be used.

You can:

- use these as inspiration or bring your own passion project
- join or form a team around a problem to solve on Day 1
- form a team with others and agree a problem to solve ahead ahead of the event – you must disclose any work you have done before Day 1 of the Hack

Do you have your own problem to solve but **would like some help** finding a subject matter expert or the right datasets?

Feel free to approach the mentors

Suggested Problem: Food Waste Challenge

The Problem

- An estimated 32% of food is wasted globally (13% along supply chains, 19% by consumers).
- Food waste breaks down in landfills to produce methane, a potent greenhouse gas contributing to climate change.
- In NZ, 1 in 5 children live in food-insecure households, and over 10% of New Zealanders face food insecurity.
- Wasted food also wastes land, fresh water (25% globally), energy, packaging, and transport emissions.

AI Opportunities & Ideas

- Predictive Analytics: Forecast when and where surplus or waste is likely to occur.
- Demand Forecasting: Improve inventory management and supply chain planning to prevent overproduction.
- Redistribution Logistics: Optimize food rescue operations to connect surplus food with communities in need.
- Impact Measurement: Track environmental, social, and economic benefits of food redistribution.

Suggested Problem: Facilities Helpdesk AI Agent

The Problem

- Enterprise maintenance requests rely heavily on manual steps, separate process knowledge, and email follow-up.
- Desktop-only legacy tools prevent staff away from workstations from easily raising requests.
- Lack of real-time progress visibility leads to unnecessary email queries and wasted coordination time.
- Critical hazard escalations and priority assessments are not surfaced contextually when logging issues.

AI Opportunities & Ideas

- Natural Language Intake: Build conversational experiences to report maintenance needs using plain language.
- Intelligent Classification: Apply priority models (P0-P4) automatically based on request details.
- Contextual Escalation: Automatically detect health & safety risks and surface emergency contacts instantly.
- Automated Updates: Proactively notify requesters on progress, eliminating manual email coordination.

Suggested Problem: Accessible Peer Support Platforms

The Problem

- Disabled people and their whānau often face barriers finding advocacy networks, mentors, and local support resources.
- Access to training and peer connection is frequently fragmented, making self-determination difficult.
- Services must empower individuals according to 'Enabling Good Lives' principles, placing disabled voices in control.
- Standard digital interfaces are often not accessible to those with diverse cognitive, visual, or physical impairments.

AI Opportunities & Ideas

- Intelligent Mentor Connection: Match disabled individuals with peer mentors based on lived experience and goals.
- Accessibility Assistant: Design speech, audio, and sign-language translation helpers for training and resource navigation.
- Plain Language Summarizer: Convert complex legal rights or service guides into clear, accessible formats.
- Inclusive UI Design: Build interfaces that adjust to individual user accessibility requirements dynamically.

AI Forum



TECH
NEW ZEALAND
Community

Judging Scorecard & Awards

The Scorecard (Equally Weighted)

- **Inspiration:** defined problem with real-world impact with a solution that excites.
- **Technology:** feasibility, quality, and AI use.
- **Design & Innovation:** usability, and originality.
- **Presentation:** Clear, structured, and creative (and timing)

Awards & Prizes

- **Local Prize (\$250):** Awarded to the best solution for the Waikato Hackathon.
- **TAIAO Prize (\$1,000):** National prize for outstanding alignment with the UN SDGs, feasibility, and impact.
- **Technical Brilliance Prize (\$1,000):** National prize awarded by national judges for exceptional technical thinking and prototype execution.

Note: All local venue winners will be submitted to the national judging panel for the Summit finals.



AI Hackathon

AI Hackathon Festival 2026

Pitch deck template



30
seconds

CONNECT

Connect with your audience

Think of it like speed dating – you have 30 seconds to make your first impression – and that first impression could change your life (and everyone else's) FOREVER

- Who are you and what is your passion?



1
minute

PROBLEM TO SOLVE

What is the problem you are trying to solve? and Why should I care?

- Who or what does it impact?
- Humanise it – Create empathy for the creatures (human or otherwise) impacted
- Use a short story and KILLER DATA (this is an AI Hack after all)

Make sure you describe the problem you are solving (not necessarily the one that you set out to solve)



2
minutes

YOUR BIG IDEA

Explain your innovation

- How does it solve the problem?
- AND how does your innovation meet the brief?
- Show us your prototype (High Fidelity or Click-through slideware is fine)

FUTURE IMPACT

1.5
minutes

IMPACT

- What will your innovation change?
- Be compelling –Why should I care?

WHAT DO YOU NEED?

- What do you need to make this work?

FUTURE

- What could this mean for the future? (FOR OUR FUTURE?)



Recraft AI:

Turning Commercial Waste
into Community Treasure



Recraft AI

Made with GAMMA

ZV

Zz HAM L2 Victoria (16ppl – Teams) - ...

NL

Nick Lim

GC

Guilherme Weigert ...

KF

Kate Fursova